



NEERAJ AKHOURY MD, SHREE CEMENT



MANUFACTURING CEMENT

→ Shree Cement has focused on launching premium products in the market and that strategy has helped it improve average realisation per tonne by about 5% on a sequential basis

→ A key driver for high average realisation is the drop in the fuel sourcing cost with a rising share

of green energy and efficiency measures

→ In FY24, 73.5% of its cement output was blended, avoiding over 7.2 million tonnes of CO₂ emissions

→ The company's R&D efforts are focused on new-age, sustainable products

tem has been deployed to enhance alternate fuel consumption and improve thermal substitution within kilns at one of the units and is being replicated at others.

To support energy resilience, the company is implementing a 1 MW battery energy storage system at one of the units. This will allow it to store solar power and use it during non-solar hours, enhancing the efficiency of renewable energy assets.

As the cement industry shifts towards more climate-friendly options, there has been a growing demand for a procurement mandate to support the offtake of sustainable products. Akhoury believes that a policy on public procurement of blended cement can significantly accelerate decarbonisation.

"Mandating its use in public infrastructure projects will align government-funded development with national decarbonisation goals, drive demand for blended cement products and promote circular economy," Akhoury adds.

Shree Cement sees sustainability not as a goal, but as a way of doing business by integrating environmental responsibility into every aspect of operations. It aims to lead by example and build sidings at various plants to streamline transportation and reduce dependence on conventional road logistics. This initiative will not only enhance the speed and reliability of material movement but also help reduce emissions associated with freight," he explains further.

In recognition of such initiatives, Shree Cement has been picked as a winner in BT India's Most Sustainable Companies 2025 awards in the Cement category. **BT**

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